ACC
ANTI-CORRUPTION COMMISSION

COMMISSION MEETING FORM

MEETING NO.	14th Commission Meeting
DATE:	04 February 2026
TIME:	02:00 PM
VENUE:	*Druk Dradhir Khang*

#	AGENDA & DISCUSSION	DECISION
1	Update on commemoration of NACD – DoPE *ED sought the Commission's directives on the commemoration of the upcoming NACD. The discussion recalled that the initial direction was to observe NACD at the PRO, pursuant to which preparatory steps had been initiated, including coordination with the Dungkhag and other stakeholders to allocate time during the celebration of the Birth Anniversary of His Majesty The King.* *However, in view of changing priorities and the subsequent Commission decision to coordinate the commemoration at the Head Office, the ED sought further guidance. To this, the Commissioner In-Charge updated the Commission that, following earlier discussions, a submission had been made to the Hon'ble Minister, MoESD.* *The meeting also recalled past practices of aligning NACD build-up activities with the Birth Anniversary of His Royal Highness The Gyalsey, noting that ongoing advocacy and interactive programs with youth, including those implemented by the Regional Offices, could be considered as part of the NACD build-up.* *The discussion further noted that, in light of the upcoming GMC volunteering program, the NACD may be observed modestly, consistent with past practice, with the virtual launch of two education initiatives, namely the revised DAMTSI module for ECCD and Institute of Science & Mind (ISM) content. Reference was also made to the previous year's practice, where the DAMTSI Evaluation Report was launched through a modest program at the TRO.* *Additional suggestions included the production of a short video for broadcast on BBS, focusing on youth and integrity, and featuring key messages from dignitaries, including the Hon'ble Minister, MoESD, to be aired as part of regular news program. ED also proposed*	**Decided to commemorate the NACD at the Head Office, with the virtual launch of the revised DAMTSI module for ECCD and ISM content. In this regard, the ED was directed to:** - **check the availability of the Hon'ble Minister, MoESD to jointly launch the initiatives with partners, rather than through an internal only event.** - **plan the program accordingly whether *virtual or in-person* and include participation of relevant partners.** - **re-submit the proposed program to the Commission at least one week in advance for review and guidance.** - **prepare messages for the Day from the Chairperson and the Hon'ble Minister and other key persons.** - **issue a media release.** - **coordinate the broadcast of video messages prior to NACD noting that the Day coincides with the observance of His Majesty's Birth Anniversary.**

	conducting a public poll on awareness of NACD, which need not be limited to the day itself but could form part of the pre-commemoration build-up activities.	
2	Present draft 2nd Quarterly Trend Analysis Report – DoPS *CFD presented the draft Trend Analysis Report focusing on post investigation administrative referrals. The presentation highlighted the effectiveness of the 30 days Turnaround Time (TAT) provided to agencies for submission of Action Taken Reports (ATRs), as well as the systemic changes implemented by agencies pursuant to these ATRs.* *The scope of the study covered types of administrative actions, TAT compliance, and comparative patterns across agency categories, among other indicators. The analysis revealed a gradual improvement in average TAT, from 94 days in FY 2022-2023, to 83 days in FY 2023-2024, and further to 74 days in FY 2024-2025, indicating an improving trend in agency responsiveness.* *Disaggregated by agency category, the study showed that Thromde offices recorded the highest average TAT at 152 days, while Financial Institutions and Corporations recorded the lowest at 55 days, although still exceeding the stipulated 30 days TAT. With regard to the enforcement of administrative actions, the report noted that recoveries in kind took an average of 524 days, significantly longer than cases involving severe actions. This was attributed, in part, to HRCs of agencies deliberating extensively on serious matters, while relatively straightforward actions did not always receive comparable attention.* *The analysis further indicated that minor sanctions were imposed more frequently than major sanctions, with 98 minor sanctions in FY 2022-2023 compared to 59 in FY 2024-2025 and 45 major sanctions in FY 2022-2023 compared to 36 in FY 2024-2025. However, the report also observed a growing consistency among agencies in enforcing major sanctions over time.* *Based on these findings, CFD proposed the following recommendations for the Commission's consideration:* - *Increase the TAT from 30 days to 60 days;* - *Strengthen leadership accountability for timely and effective implementation of ATRs; and* - *Advocate and sensitize Heads of Agencies (HoA) through direct engagement with clear articulation of expectations.* *During the discussion, the Commission emphasized the importance of understanding how many agencies have formally requested extensions, as an indicator of the*	**Endorsed the report with the following specific directives:** - **maintain the 30 days TAT for submission of ATRs, with an enhanced monitoring mechanism including automated email reminders prior to deadlines.** - **record all communications made while monitoring the progress of referrals.** - **DoI to ensure that referral letters clearly state the mandatory requirement for agencies to respond within the stipulated TAT, and that failure to comply will attract accountability of the HoA, including referral to AIMS and IVS.** - **incorporate the TAT compliance parameter within AIMS and IVS to enable systematic tracking and enforcement.**

	seriousness and commitment of agency leadership. It was further noted that extending the TAT alone may not resolve underlying compliance issues, and that there is a need for a systematic tracking and reminder mechanism. *In this regard, the discussion proposed establishing a trigger-based monitoring mechanism, including automated reminders prior to deadlines, similar to compliance tracking for international obligations. It was suggested that a reminder be issued one working day before the deadline, with failure to respond triggering referral to the AIMS and IVS.* *In addition, the DoPS proposed that the next Trend Analysis Report focus on agencies that consistently fail to respond to ATRs, examining the reasons for non-compliance, reluctance in enforcing administrative actions, and patterns of institutional avoidance.* *Trend Analysis Report and PowerPoint presentation is attached.*	
3	Update on the mandatory training – SS *HRS presented an update on the mandatory training program conducted from 5-25 January 2026, which was attended by 25 participants, comprising of 11 from the ACC, 7 from the RAA, 2 from the OAG, and 5 from the ECB. The program was delivered by 27 Resource Persons, including one from the OAG.* *The overall assessment of the training reflected a positive outcome with team-building sessions receiving the highest rating (4.63) while meals the lowest (3.58). Other key ratings included:* - *accommodation (4.25),* - *training content (4.49), and* - *presentation (4.36).* *Participants highlighted following strength:* - *exceptional team-building sessions,* - *high-quality accommodation,* - *strong facilitation and content delivery,* - *successful inter-agency networking,* - *appreciation of practical sessions, and* - *effective administrative coordination.* *However, feedback also noted instances of content repetition.* *Suggestions for improvement included addressing menu repetition, improving time management (particularly sessions running late), providing weekend breaks, reducing excessive theoretical content in some sessions, and incorporating more case-based learning.* *In terms of budget, the total expenditure amounted to Nu. 0.941 million against an allocated budget of Nu.*	**Noted with following specific directives:** - **strengthen networking at operational and technical levels among agencies, in addition to the Tripartite Forum, which primarily engages senior leadership.** - **SS to sit with the training participants and plan the menu.** and catering company - **engage the OAG in advance to encourage maximum participation in future programs.** - **seek structured feedback from participants of other agencies on the relevance of the training and identify additional areas to enhance its value for them.** - **develop a comprehensive training manual covering all sessions to ensure long-term institutional sustainability, with scope for contributions from trainees.** - **continue conducting the program at the PDC.**

	1.74 million. The cost reduction was attributed mainly to the initial plan to conduct the training at RIGSS. *HRS informed that the training report will be shared with the Mandatory Training Committee for information and further reference.*	
4	Present tentative agenda for the Tripartite Meeting among the ACC, RAA, and RCSC – SS & PPD *PPD apprised the Commission of a proposal from the RCSC to convene a Tripartite Meeting among the ACC, RAA, and RCSC, tentatively scheduled for 27 February 2026 at the RCSC. In this regard, the RCSC shared the following tentative agenda items:* - *Streamlining administrative actions;* - *Planning for joint work on advisory functions; and* - *Sharing service delivery experiences and identifying measures for strengthening them.* *The RCSC has also requested the ACC to propose agenda items for inclusion in the meeting.* *In this regard, PPD sought guidance from the Commission on the tentative agenda items from the ACC.*	**Noted and directed the following:** - **DoPS to undertake further groundwork on ATRs relating to minor and major administrative actions, with particular emphasis on the nature and adequacy of actions taken, among others.** - **include the issue of administrative appeals being addressed by the RCSC in cases with corruption-related elements, noting that such matters fall within the mandate of the ACC.** - **include pending approval on the talent retention and management proposal.** - **present all tentative agenda items to the Commission for comprehensive deliberation and resolution on 16/17 February 2026.**
5	Update on the collaboration with the ACC Maldives – PPD *PPD apprised the Commission of an update received from the ACC Maldives regarding the invitation extended to visit Bhutan. In this regard, the ACC Maldives enquired whether the ACC could extend any financial support in the event that a delegation from Maldives visits Bhutan.*	**Given that the ACC Maldives will be bearing the costs for ACC officials to visit Maldives as resource persons for training and other collaborative initiatives, decided to extend modest local hospitality to the visiting delegation from the ACC Maldives, including 3/4-star accommodation, local transportation, and meals.**

6	Present draft proposal on hosting a workshop during upcoming International Anti-Corruption Conference – PPD *PPD presented a draft proposal to host thematic workshops during the upcoming TI's International Anti-Corruption Conference (IACC) themed "**Igniting the Power of Integrity**" scheduled to be held from 1-4 December 2026 in Punta Cana, Dominican Republic.* *PPD informed that the proposed workshops are aligned with the IACC's following thematic tracks:* - *Defending Democracy and Freedoms: Integrity as our Shield;* - *Protecting People of Integrity: Standing with the Frontliners;* - *Corruption, Conflict, and Security: Breaking the Cycle of Violence;* - *Integrity for People and Planet Regeneration: Fighting the Theft of Our Future;* - *Leading the Way: Business Integrity as a Force for Global Change;* - *Igniting Youth Action: The Integrity Leaders of Today and Tomorrow;* - *The Future is Today: Shaping the Tech Innovation Race; and* - *Strategy Sessions: Innovation, Movements, and Coalitions – The Power of Integrity in Action.* *Against this backdrop, PPD proposed the following two workshops:* 1. ***Youth Integrity Program: A Strategic Investment in Building a Values-Based Society – The Bhutan Experience*** ***Objective:** To share Bhutan's experience in youth-centered integrity education, highlight collaborative approaches underpinning its success, and promote cross-national learning on practical strategies for nurturing values-based societies.* ***Format and Expertise**: Proposed as a panel-based discussion, moderated or facilitated by TI, with panelists including representatives from the ACC (Commission and DoPE), MoESD, a youth representative, and a regional Anti-Corruption Agency (ACA).* 2. ***An Effective Asset Disclosure System: An Antidote to Power-Driven Corruption Risks (Managing PEPs, Revolving Doors, and Conflicts of Interest)*** ***Objective**: To examine how robust asset declaration systems can prevent power-driven corruption risks, including conflicts of interest,*	**Endorsed the proposal with the following specific directives:** - **include children as one of the target audiences, considering the DAMTSI Activity Book's early integrity education at ECCD.** - **include 'strengthen the exchange of best practices among ACAs including the ACC' for both the workshops under the expected impact and follow-up actions.** - **explore panelist from Lithuania, Austria, Singapore, and EU given the relevance to proposed workshop themes.** - **confirm whether Estonia will participate in the conference.** - **explore funding support from the Conference Secretariat to offset costs associated with hosting the proposed workshops.**

	revolving doors, and PEP-related vulnerabilities, drawing on Bhutan's experience and international good practices. ***Format and Expertise**: Proposed as a panel debate, moderated/facilitated and documented by TI, with expert participation from the ACC, Estonia, and the OECD.* *PPD further informed that workshops, whichever gets selected, would entail an estimated budget of approximately Nu. 1.939 million or more depending on the involvement of experts.*	
7	Present analysis on the TI CPI data sources – PPD *PPD presented an analysis of Bhutan's performance in the Transparency International Corruption Perceptions Index (TI-CPI) including an overview of the CPI methodology, global trends, Bhutan's comparative standing, and key data sources contributing to the score.* *The presentation recalled that the TI-CPI measures perceived public sector corruption, ranking 180 countries and territories on a scale from 0 (highly corrupt) to 100 (very clean), based on expert assessments and business surveys. The CPI focuses on abuse of authority for private gain including bribery, diversion of public funds, and weaknesses in accountability mechanisms. Globally, the 2025 CPI shows that two-thirds of countries score below 50, with a global average of 43, indicating persistent governance and accountability challenges worldwide.* *Against this global context, Bhutan scored 72/100 in CPI 2025, ranking 18th globally, 3rd in Asia, and 5th in the Asia-Pacific region, reaffirming Bhutan's position among the least corrupt public sectors globally. However, it was noted that the score reflects perceptions derived from multiple external data sources and therefore requires careful interpretation and strategic engagement.* *PPD highlighted that Bhutan's CPI score is derived from four key international data sources, namely:* 1. ***World Bank Country Policy and Institutional Assessment (CPIA)**, particularly the dimension on Transparency, Accountability, and Corruption in the Public Sector;* 2. ***Global Insight Country Risk Ratings**, focusing on Control of Corruption;* 3. ***Bertelsmann Transformation Index (BTI)**, covering Prosecution of Office Abuse and Anti-Corruption Policy; and*	**Noted with following specific directives:** - **PPD to coordinate bilateral meetings with key responsible institutions, including the PMO, RCoJ, National Assembly, National Council, Office of Opposition Leader, and the GGCs of the National Assembly and National Council, among others.** - **PPD to engage with the World Bank Country Office to inform on the TI-CPI analysis.** - **PPD to coordinate a bilateral meeting between the V-Dem team and the Commission during any upcoming regional or international forum.**

	4. ***Varieties of Democracy (V-Dem) Project***, *measuring Political, Executive, Public Sector, Legislative, and Judicial Corruption.* *The analysis showed that World Bank CPIA scores improved significantly, with Bhutan scoring 4.5 out of 6, reflecting strong checks and balances, transparency in decision-making, separation between public and private interests, and safeguards over public funds and procurement systems. Similarly, Global Insight assessed bribery risks as low, noting that corruption does not pose a significant obstacle to business, although marginal perception risks remain due to administrative discretion.* *BTI rated Bhutan highly on anti-corruption policy (9/10) and prosecution of office abuse (8/10), acknowledging a generally effective legal and institutional framework, while also pointing to implementation and enforcement gaps.* *However, the V-Dem data highlighted comparatively lower scores in judicial corruption and public sector corrupt exchanges, indicating perceived vulnerabilities in judicial decision-making, petty corruption, and enforcement consistency. These areas were identified as key perception risks influencing Bhutan's overall CPI score.* *Based on these findings and recalling the Commission's directives, PPD apprised that the TI-CPI analysis would be used to inform the development of the next National Anti-Corruption Strategy, with a clear articulation of the roles and responsibilities of the ACC and all key stakeholders, including the executive, judiciary, legislature, law enforcement agencies, corporations, civil society, media, and the private sector, in collectively strengthening Bhutan's anti-corruption regime.*	
8	Others - *Next Tripartite Forum among the ACC, RAA, and OAG.* *Recalling the successful conduct of the previous Tripartite Forum at the PDC, the Commission discussed the importance of sustaining and institutionalizing professional collegiality and constructive engagement among the ACC, RAA, and OAG through continued Tripartite Forums.* - *Leave Administration* *Considering the importance of avoiding communication gaps between direct supervisors and staff during periods of leave as well as the need for timely and informed decision-making,*	**Directed PPD to explore convening the next Tripartite Forum at a remote location, other than the PDC or PRO, to further strengthen team building and professional collegiality among the institutions.** **Decided that leave applications of officials directly reporting to the Chairperson or the Commissioner In-Charge shall**

	particularly in cases of long leave (beyond 5 days), the Commission discussed the necessity of streamlining the leave approval process. In this regard, it was noted that leave applications should be approved by the respective direct supervisors, with only those officials directly reporting to the Chairperson or Commissioners requiring approval at that level. *The Commission further noted that the absence of email notifications and reliance on approval through system alone has resulted in the accumulation of pending leave applications in the system, highlighting the need for improved notification and approval mechanisms.* - *GMC Volunteering from 21-25 February 2026* *SS apprised that 28 officials have registered for the volunteering service.*	**require approval at that level, while all other leave applications shall be approved by the respective direct supervisors. Further directed to enable an email notification system with a built-in approval feature to facilitate timely leave approvals and prevent accumulation of pending requests.** **Directed the SS to facilitate coordination of accommodation and carpooling arrangements.**

Commissioner **Commissioner** **Chairperson**